Sofia's Practice Toolkit

The 15-week plan to the Winter Showcase · Sep 28 → Sat Jan 9, 2027

Glass House Dance · Team PITCH
Solo · Trio · 2026–27

Four parts, one goal

Each part has a different job. Don't skip ahead. Ms. Brittany: **memorize first, then improve the moves and tricks.**

1
Own it
Weeks 1–6 · Sep 28–Nov 8

Know every step with **no video and no one to follow**. Solo: Hannah's two videos, step by step, copying arms, feet, head and eyes. A teacher's new correction: **use it right away**. Knees over toes.

2
Clean it
Weeks 7–9 · Nov 9–Nov 29

Feet, knees, arms, eyes. **One fix at a time:** on to the next once it shows on **two videos in a row**. Trick preps look like dancing. Thanksgiving week: the 15-minute memory run.

3
Perform it
Weeks 10–14 · Nov 30–Jan 3

Focal points, stamina, costume on. **One full-out every session**, two back to back on Sundays. 2–3 mini audiences. Hold every ending.

4
Taper
Week 15 · Jan 4–9

Fewer runs from Dec 28, still one full-out. One run a day. Nothing new. No deep stretching. Night before: memory run only. Sleep. **Show Sat Jan 9!**

Big checkpoints

Sat Oct 31	Whole **trio**, no video, nobody marking	☐
Sun Nov 1	Whole **solo** from memory, on the music	☐
Next solo rehearsal	Show Ms. Brittany: no missed steps	☐
Sun Nov 29	Every solo fix checked on page 4	☐
Dec 14 week	Solo in costume (twice in Dec) · stage taped out	☐
Nov 30–Jan 3	3 mini audiences (video call, after class, friends)	☐
Sat Jan 2	Mandatory rehearsal: back from break!	☐
Thu Jan 7	Mini show for the family	☐
Fri Jan 8	Night before: memory run only, early bed	☐
Sat Jan 9	**Winter Showcase ★**	☐

My week

Mon	Ballet · Acro · Jazz Tech at the studio. **Rest at home.**
Tue	Hip Hop · Ballroom. **Rest at home.**
Wed	Contemporary · solo rehearsal with Ms. Brittany when booked · **15-minute memory run**
Thu	HOME: strong + bendy + trio section + solo
Fri	HOME: technique + this week's trick + solo
Sat	Co Tech · PITCH rehearsal
Sun	HOME: FILM the solo + trio section + film review

Trio privates with Larisa 1–2× a month. Home sessions are 35–40 minutes; from Nov 9 each one ends with **Show in your head** (page 3). **Never 2 days in a row without the solo:** on a class, rehearsal or make-up day, the 15-minute memory run.

After the Showcase

Press Play Jan 15–17 (classes only) → Hollywood Connection Jan 22–24 → Ryze Feb 19–21 → iD Feb 26–28 → Gravit8 Mar 12–14 → Hollywood Vibe Apr 30–May 2 → Showstopper May 14–16 → Glass House Ball Jun 19–20. Then the plan restarts: own it, clean it, perform it, in shorter loops between comps.

Point. Straighten. Eyes up. Long arms. Hit the beat. Hold the end.

My 15-week tracker

Check a box for every home practice. Sunday: write your ONE fix for next week.

Thu · Fri · Sun
F = filmed

WK	WEEK OF	SOLO GOAL	TRIO GOAL	FRI TRICK	THU	FRI	SUN	F	MY ONE FIX
1 · OWN IT									
1	Sep 28	0:00–0:48 from memory	0:00–0:22 opening + floor phrase	1 Side-sit reach	☐	☐	☐	☐	
2	Oct 5	0:48–2:04 from memory	0:22–0:42 stillness → crawl	2 Heel stretch	☐	☐	☐	☐	
3	Oct 12	**Hannah video 1**, step by step	0:42–1:04 CANON: know my count	Memory + knees	☐	☐	☐	☐	
4	Oct 19	**Hannah video 2**, step by step	1:04–2:17 runs → bridges → end	Memory + knees	☐	☐	☐	☐	
1 · OWN IT (CONTINUED) · MS. BRITTANY'S HOMEWORK									
5	Oct 26	**Whole solo from memory**, on the counts	**Whole trio, no video by Sat**	Memory + knees	☐	☐	☐	☐	
6	Nov 2	Whole solo ×2, no stops · show Ms. B	0:22 stillness: one shared focus	Knees over toes	☐	☐	☐	☐	
2 · CLEAN IT · SHOW IN YOUR HEAD EVERY HOME SESSION · ONE FIX UNTIL IT SHOWS ON 2 VIDEOS IN A ROW									
7	Nov 9	Floor work: point + straighten · side leg: pick one	0:30 arabesque on knees: height + lock	1 Side-sit reach	☐	☐	☐	☐	
8	Nov 16	Long arms · high passé · trick preps are dancing	0:52–0:58 wait in a SHAPE · 0:58 arms	6 Passé turns	☐	☐	☐	☐	
9	Nov 23 · light	15-minute memory run only	Say the counts out loud	Rest	☐	☐	☐	☐	
3 · PERFORM IT · ONE FULL-OUT EVERY SESSION · TWO BACK TO BACK ON SUNDAYS									
10	Nov 30	Donut roll · a focal point for every section · **mini audience #1** (video call)	Dance BIGGER when upstage	8 Donut roll	☐	☐	☐	☐	
11	Dec 7	Two full-outs back to back (Sun)	Whole trio with music ×2	3 Leap + cartwheel · 4 Walkover + handstand	☐	☐	☐	☐	
12	Dec 14 · costume	Full run IN costume · **tape out the stage** · **mini audience #2**	Match Lauren's size	5 Floor kick	☐	☐	☐	☐	
13	Dec 21	Hold the ending to 2:00 · **mini audience #3** (after class)	Hold last picture past 2:12	7 The ending	☐	☐	☐	☐	
14	Dec 28 · fewer runs	Costume run #2 · show face on · one full-out a session · sleep 9–12 h	Whole trio · ready for Sat Jan 2	My weakest	☐	☐	☐	☐	
4 · TAPER									
15	Jan 4	One run a day · mini show Thu · Fri: memory run only	One run (if with the girls)	Nothing new	☐	☐	☐	☐	**SHOW SAT JAN 9 ★**

Sticker rule

One sticker for every home practice. 3 in a week = **full week ★**. At each checkpoint on page 1, pick a reward with Mom (a movie night, a new scrunchie, choosing Saturday breakfast).

Teachers win · one fix at a time

If Ms. Brittany, Larisa or Hannah gives a new correction, **practise it right away**: it becomes this week's fix instead of the one on this page. A fix is done when it shows on **two videos in a row**; then start the next one.

How to practice at home

The best way to get better between classes: short, often, one thing at a time

For Sofia
and her grown-up

The home session · 35–40 minutes

5 min	**Warm up.** Jumping jacks, arm circles, leg swings, light jog. Always first.
8 min	**Strong.** Hollow hold + superman 3×20s · plank + side plank 2×20–30s · slow relevés 2×15 · one-leg balance 20s · lying leg lifts 2×10.
7 min	**Bendy**, after warm-up only. Right, left, middle split + straddle, 20–30s each. A stretch, never pain.
5 min	**Knees + technique.** Pliés in 1st and 2nd facing the mirror 2×8, knees over toes. Slow lunges 2×5 each side. Relevés. Tricks wait until the solo is memorized.
10 min	**The dances.** Trio: this week's section (page 5). Solo: until Nov 9 from the top as far as you know; from Nov 9 **one full-out**, eyes up (two back to back on Sundays from Nov 30). Until Nov 29: **film one chunk**, watch it when you want, try again.
6 min	**Show in your head** FROM NOV 9 The script on the right.

Mon and Tue are rest days at home. Solo rehearsals are booked as needed. On a rehearsal, class or make-up day, the light week (Nov 23) and the night before the show, do the **15-minute memory run** instead. Never 2 days in a row without the solo.

Learn it so it sticks

1. **One chunk.** Solo: use **Hannah's two videos**. Watch one 8-count, pause, do it, then go on to the next 8.
2. **Slow.** Do it at half speed 3×, copying arms, feet, head and eyes right from the start. The app practice player can slow the music to 75%.
3. **Music.** Do it with the real music.
4. **No help.** Turn away from the video and the mirror. Do it alone.
5. **Say it.** Say the move names out loud while you mark. Words are a second memory.
6. **Chain it.** Add the chunk to the one before it, then run both.
7. **Pause-and-predict.** Mom pauses the video anywhere. Sofia says and shows what comes next. When she never has to guess, the step is learned.
8. **From the top.** Every session: start at the beginning, go as far as you know, then add ONE new chunk.

Set up a dance spot

- ☐ Clear space, with the mat out for anything upside down
- ☐ Tape an **X** on the floor for "center front"
- ☐ A sticker on the wall = **the judges**. Dance to it.
- ☐ Phone on a stand at the **side** for filming
- ☐ Music ready on the app: the real track for each dance
- ☐ Water bottle, hair up, socks off for floor work
- ☐ Once in December: **tape out the stage size** for a costume run

Grown-up's job

- **Be the stage crew**, not the teacher: music, timer, filming, stickers.
- Ask, don't correct: "What comes next?" "Where do your eyes go?" "Which fix are you working on?"
- Keep corrections to what the teachers gave. A teacher's new one goes into practice **right away**. If something looks off, write it under *Questions for my teachers*.
- **Video:** let Sofia choose when to watch her clips. Every review starts with what went well.
- Praise the work: "You kept your eyes up the whole time," not "you're so talented."
- Start at the same time each practice day. A routine beats willpower.

Show in your head FROM NOV 9

1. Stand in your opening pose, in your dance clothes.
2. Play the real song, full speed.
3. Close your eyes. See the stage, the lights, the judges' table.
4. Dance it in your head through your own eyes; let your arms and head mark small.
5. Feel the story. Slow, calm breaths.
6. Hold the ending until the very last note.
7. Do it 2–3 times. The last time, watch yourself from the audience.

A grown-up reads the steps out loud for the first two weeks. Picturing it at bedtime is extra and optional: never let it push bedtime later.

Safety rules

- Warm up before stretching. No oversplits, no forcing.
- Acro only on the mat or with a spotter. Kick-overs and aerials only in class.
- If it hurts, stop and tell a grown-up.
- Stop before tired. Tired teaches the wrong way.
- **Sleep 9–12 hours**, same bedtime every night.

★ Solo · Stay a Little Longer

Lyrical · choreography Hannah · rehearsals with Ms. Brittany when booked · 2:04 track

Soft 0:00–0:48
Full 0:48–1:52 · fade

Where the moves land · checked Oct 25 · photos on the cue cards

START	MOVE	I LOOK AT...
0:00	Opening walk, tendus, arm reach	
0:07	Drop to the floor, sit	
0:10.5	**★ Side-sit leg reach**	
0:12.5	Slide out long, curl, kneeling arms	
0:16.5	**★ Kneeling arch, tip onto hands, leg kicks up**	
0:19.5	Side roll, long stretch	
0:22	Rise, travel, arms up	
0:31.5	**★ Heel stretch, leg held high**	
0:34	Deep lunge · hands behind head · run, kicks	
0:43.75	Gather: fold, V arms, run-up	
0:48	**★ LEAP on the swell**	
0:49.5	**★ Cartwheel**	
0:52	High kick, turns, lunges, arms	

START	MOVE	I LOOK AT...
1:07.75	**★ Walkover to knees** (handstand, bridge, knees)	
1:10.5	Kneeling arms, kneeling leg kick	
1:17	Run to the mat	
1:18.25	**★ Donut roll on the mat**	
1:21	Traveling, passé on the mat	
1:28.5	**★ Handstand**, split legs, step down to sit	
1:30.5	Floor section, straddle at 1:38	
1:40.75	**★ Floor kick**	
1:42.5	Rise, turn + kick, drop, lunge up	
1:49.5	**★ Passé turns**, arms overhead	
1:53	V arms, lower to sit	
1:57.5	Seated leg lift	
2:00.5	**★ Floor ending:** curl on your side, hold	

My fixes · one at a time · check when the teacher says "yes"

Done on video = it shows on two videos in a row. Then the teacher checks it.

- ☐ **Knees over toes** in every plié, lunge, landing and floor entry. No knees falling in. *(Ms. Brittany, Oct 13)*
- ☐ **Point + straighten** on every floor extension, even as the leg comes down
- ☐ **Side leg: pick one.** A clean attitude or straight. Never halfway.
- ☐ **Eyes up.** No mirror, no teacher. Every section has a spot.
- ☐ **Long arms.** Elbows straight overhead, shoulders down.
- ☐ **Passé high.** Toe beside the knee, high relevé, sharp spot.
- ☐ **Trick prep is dancing.** Head stays up until the hands go down.
- ☐ **Donut roll:** chin tucked, over the shoulder, chest leads.
- ☐ **Hold the ending** until 2:00, when the sound is gone.

Trick ladder · starts Nov 9, after the solo is memorized

Check **Can do** (alone), **Clean ×3** (3 in a row), **In the dance** (on the beat in a full run).

TRICK	THE DRILL	CAN DO	CLEAN ×3	IN THE DANCE
1 · Side-sit leg reach 0:10.5	Sit on one hip, hand on the floor. Leg straight up: 4 counts up, hold 2, 4 down. 6 each side. Arm slides up the leg. "*Push the floor, reach the toe.*"	☐	☐	☐
2 · Heel stretch 0:31.5	Développé side at a counter: 4 up, hold 2, 4 down ×6. Side-lying leg lifts 2×12. Standing heel down.	☐	☐	☐
3 · Leap + cartwheel 0:48 · 0:49.5	Leap ON the swell, then cartwheel: reach, look, place. Cartwheel over a tape line, legs straight. Play from 0:44 ×5.	☐	☐	☐
4 · Walkover to knees 1:07.75 + handstand 1:28.5	Wrists first. Wall handstand 3×10–15s. Kick up to vertical ×5, split at the top ×5. Kick-overs only with a spotter.	☐	☐	☐
5 · Floor kick 1:40.75	8 slow kicks each side, 4 up, 4 down, pointed at the top. Kick from the hip, back long.	☐	☐	☐
6 · Passé turns 1:49.5	Passé balance on relevé 10s. Quarter ×8, half ×8, singles ×10. Spot a sticker.	☐	☐	☐
7 · The ending 2:00.5	Last 15 seconds of the real track ×5. Hold, breathe, count 8 more after you think it's over.	☐	☐	☐
8 · Donut roll 1:18.25	Mat only. Cobra + seal 20s first. Kneel, sit back, roll back over ONE SHOULDER (head to the side, chin tucked), up to the knees ×5. Never over the head.	☐	☐	☐

★ Trio · Enjoy the Silence

Contemporary · choreography + teacher Larisa · with Hannah and Lauren · 2:17 slow cover, ~86 BPM

Larisa's rule: memorize first, clean in privates

Memory map

Video → with music → no help. Check a box only when it runs clean **twice**. One section per Thursday and Sunday (see the tracker).

TIME	SECTION	VIDEO	MUSIC	NO HELP ✓✓
0:00	Kneeling opening	☐	☐	☐
0:02	Lunges: back leg long and pointed	☐	☐	☐
0:04	Floor phrase: leg extensions + shoulder stand	☐	☐	☐
0:22	Kneeling STILLNESS: one shared focus	☐	☐	☐
0:28	Low crawl, arabesque on knees, seated extensions	☐	☐	☐
0:42	Rise + traveling CANON: know YOUR start count	☐	☐	☐
1:04	Runs + lunges (Lauren's acro)	☐	☐	☐
1:12	Arms-up phrase → lunges down to the floor	☐	☐	☐
1:36	THREE BRIDGES → lying	☐	☐	☐
1:50	Traveling triangle	☐	☐	☐
2:06	Ending: three-level floor picture, hold past 2:12	☐	☐	☐
WHOLE DANCE: no video, nobody marking · goal Sat Oct 31				☐

Fixes for the privates

- ☐ **Eyes:** no mirror at 0:02. In the 0:22 stillness all three eyelines agree.
- ☐ **Arabesque on knees (0:30):** match the agreed height, lock the knee.
- ☐ **Canon waiting (0:52–0:58):** hold a SHAPE with intent. Never stand "off."
- ☐ **Arms overhead (0:58):** straight, not hands to the head. Match Hannah's line.
- ☐ **Upstage = bigger.** When I'm farthest from the judges, I dance bigger.
- ☐ **Match Lauren's size.** She dances the biggest.

Already strong: shoulder stand (cleanest of the three), lunge at 0:02, bridge at 1:36, full-out runs.

The music won't help, so we do

The song stays almost the same volume until a small lift at 1:32 and fades at 2:12. The **three of you** make the big and small moments with stillness against speed.

Home trick: the canon is the hardest part. Fill in the count sheet below for 0:42–1:04 with Larisa or from the video, then **say your counts out loud** while you mark.

Canon count sheet · 0:42–1:04

Write a move name (or a doodle) in each count box. Star the count where YOU start.

8#	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8
1								
2								
3								
4								

This week

Week # ____ · Week of _____ · Print a new page every week

Fill in Sunday after the film review

Thursday · strong + bendy + trio

- ☐ Warm up 5 min
- ☐ Strong 8 min
- ☐ Bendy 7 min
- ☐ TRIO section: _____ (video → music → no help)
- ☐ Solo: from the top (from Nov 9: one full-out)
- ☐ Film one chunk, watch it, try again (until Nov 29)
- ☐ Show in your head 6 min (from Nov 9)

Friday · technique + trick

- ☐ Warm up 5 min
- ☐ Passé balances, pirouettes, kicks
- ☐ Trick: _____ (until Nov 9: knees over toes drills)
- ☐ Solo: from the top (from Nov 9: one full-out), eyes up
- ☐ Film one chunk, watch it, try again (until Nov 29)
- ☐ Show in your head 6 min (from Nov 9)

Sunday · film it

- ☐ Warm up 5 min
- ☐ Solo full out, FILMED from the side (from Nov 30: two back to back)
- ☐ Send the video to the app Coach
- ☐ TRIO section: _____
- ☐ Light stretch
- ☐ Show in your head 6 min (from Nov 9)
- ☐ Film review (right) →

Before every run, say it

Point. Straighten. Eyes up. Long arms. Hit the beat. Hold the end.

Missed 2 days? Today is the 15-minute memory run.

Sunday film review

Watch once with a grown-up. **Start with what went well.** Then write:

One thing I loved

One fix for next week (only one!)

This week's fix on the video? ☐ yes ☐ not yet (two yeses in a row → the next fix)

Best today: ☐ feet ☐ knees ☐ eyes ☐ arms

Did I hold the ending until the music stopped? ☐ yes ☐ not yet

Missed or mixed-up steps? Where: _____

App Coach said: ☐ same as my teacher ☐ something new (ask Ms. Brittany first)

What my teachers said this week

Ms. Brittany · Larisa · Isadora · Hannah. Star Ms. Brittany's top 3. New ones go into practice right away.

Questions for my teachers

How I feel about my dances

Solo: hard · okay · good · great **Trio:** hard · okay · good · great

Circle one. A "hard" week is a good week to tell Mom what feels hard.

Trio private with Larisa (if this week)

DATE	WHAT LARISA FIXED	PRACTICE THIS AT HOME